towns, district headquarters, tourist centres and minor ports within the state, and connect them with National Highways or highways of neighbouring states. These highways provide connections to industries or places from key areas in the state, making them more accessible.

State governments have the authority and responsibility to build road networks and state highways. Most of the state highways are developed by state public works departments. Independently of the NHDP program, state governments have been implementing a number of state highway projects since 2000. By 2010, state highway projects worth $1.7 billion had been completed, and projects worth an additional $11.4 billion were under implementation. Statement II: CORRECT—These are important roads within a district, connecting areas of production with markets and connecting them with the state highways and National Highways; they are maintained by the Zila Parishad. These roads also connect Taluka headquarters and rural areas to district headquarters within the state.

District roads are sub-classified into “Major District Roads” (MDRs) and “Other District Roads”. As per the broad classification of roads, the MDRs are to have a minimum width of 15 metres (49 ft) with traffic density of 5000 to 10,000 Passenger car equivalents (PCUs). As on 31 March 2016, the total length of district roads was approximately 561,940 kilometres (349,170 mi), of which 94.93% of the total length was surfaced.

18. Statement I: CORRECT—As per 2017 estimates, the total road length in India is 5,603,293 km (3,481,725 mi); making the Indian road network the second largest road network in the world after the United States. At 0.66 km of highway per square kilometre of land the density of India’s highway network is higher than that of the United States (0.65) and far higher than that of China’s (0.16) or Brazil’s (0.20).

India has a network of National Highways connecting all the major cities and state capitals, forming the economic backbone of the country. As of 2013, India has a total of 70,934 km (44,076 mi) of National Highways, of which 1,205 km (749 mi) are classified as expressways. Although India has more than 35,000 kms of